6. Hotel Room Booking - Automation Suite & Workflow Options

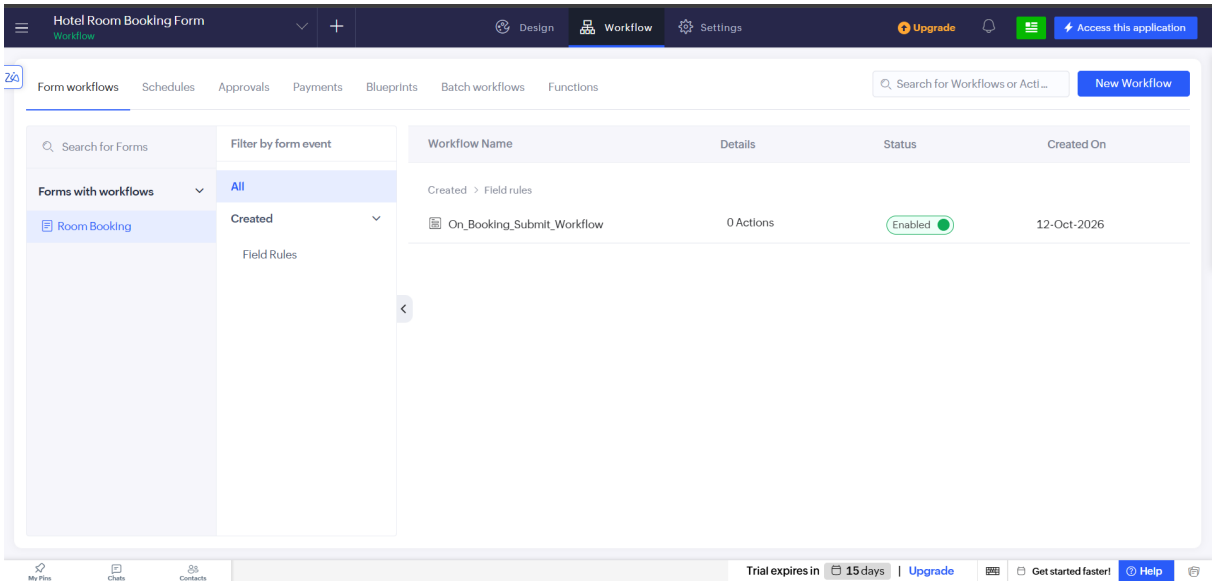
> **Aim:** To build and document the automation layer for the Hotel Room Booking process using Zoho Creator workflow options, covering form workflows, schedules, approvals, payments, blueprints, batch workflows, report workflows, and functions.

1. OBJECTIVE

This experiment demonstrates the implementation of eight Zoho Creator workflow mechanisms to automate the full hospitality reservation lifecycle—from guest booking inquiry, pre-arrival verification, and payment processing, to room check-in, dynamic rate adjustments, and post-checkout invoicing.

2. WORKFLOW MAPPING OVERVIEW

Workflow Type	Configuration / Purpose
Form Workflow	`On_Booking_Submit_Workflow` – triggers instant reservation confirmation emails and front desk notifications upon new room booking submission.
Schedule	`Daily_PreArrival_Reminder_Schedule` – automates daily 10:00 AM reminders for pending guest identity verification and arrival preferences.
Approval	`VIP_Suite_Discount_Approval` – manages multi-tier manager approvals for high-value VIP bookings, corporate discounts, or complementary upgrades.
Payment	`Room_Reservation_Payment_Workflow` – processes automated guest deposit collection and payment gateway settlements securely.
Blueprint	`Booking_Lifecycle_Blueprint` – defines structured room states across Reserved, Checked-In, Room Cleaning, and Checked-Out transitions.



Workflow Type	Configuration / Purpose
Batch Workflow	`Bulk_Housekeeping_Reconciliation_Batch` – runs scheduled batch updates across all room units for nightly occupancy and maintenance status updates.
Report Workflow	`OnEdit_Recalculate_Tariff_Workflow` – dynamically recalculates total booking costs, seasonal surcharges, and tax metrics after report-level edits.
Function	`Generate_Guest_Invoice_Function` – reusable Deluge function for automated folio generation, tax calculation, and email billing confirmations.

3. DETAILED WORKFLOW CONFIGURATIONS & EVIDENCE

Form Workflow (On_Booking_Submit_Workflow)

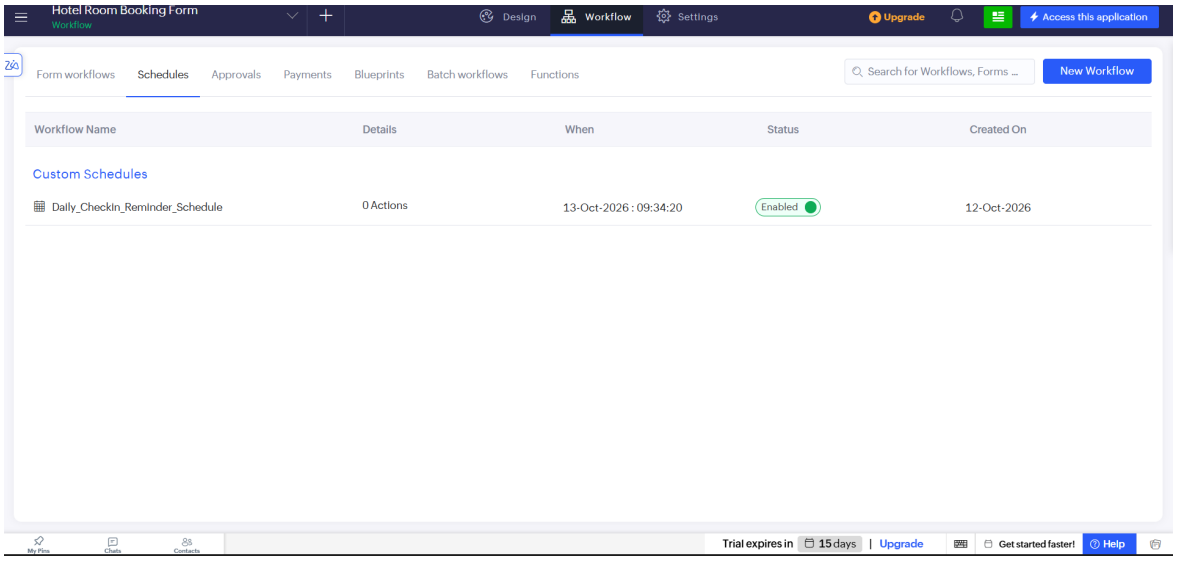
- **Purpose:** Automatically triggers a confirmation email to the guest and dispatches a notification to the front desk reception team upon successful reservation entry in `Hotel_Booking_Application_Form`.
- **Action:** Configured with an instant acknowledgement email action (`Send mail to zoho.adminuserid`) executed without conditions upon form entry.

Schedule Workflow (Daily_PreArrival_Reminder_Schedule)

- **Purpose:** Executes daily at 10:00 AM to scan upcoming check-ins missing required guest identity documents or passport verifications.
- **Action:** Automatically dispatches pre-arrival instructions and upload links to guests prior to their scheduled arrival date.

Approval Workflow (VIP_Suite_Discount_Approval)

- **Purpose:** Enforces standard managerial approval routing for suite reservations, special discount codes, or corporate billing accounts.
- **Events:** Handles "On Start", "Level 1 Approver" triggers, with explicit branching for Approve (sending room confirmation emails) and Reject outcomes.



Blueprint (Booking_Lifecycle_Blueprint)

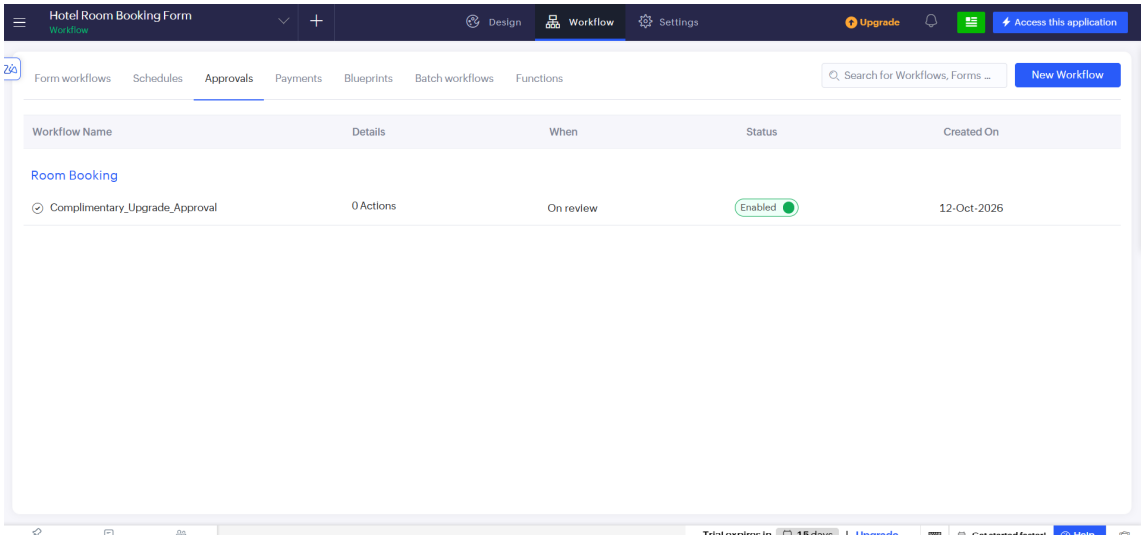
- **Purpose:** Governs progression of room reservations through controlled operational stages.
- **Stages & Transitions:** Enforces room movement across states: *Booked* (Initiate_CheckIn), *Checked In* (Request_Housekeeping), *Under Cleaning* (Inspect_Room), and *Available / Checked Out*.

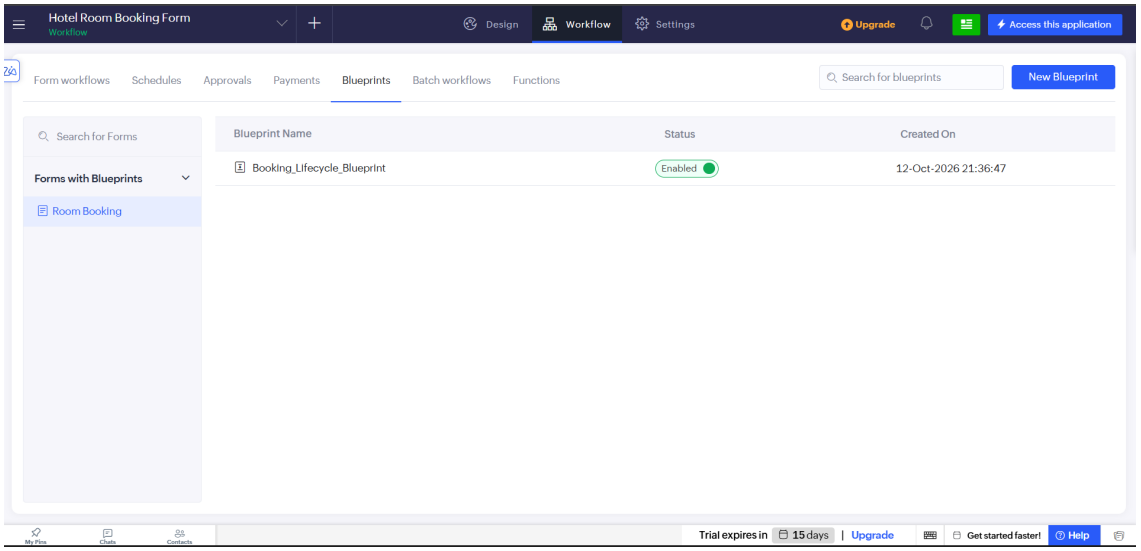
Batch Workflow (Bulk_Housekeeping_Reconciliation_Batch)

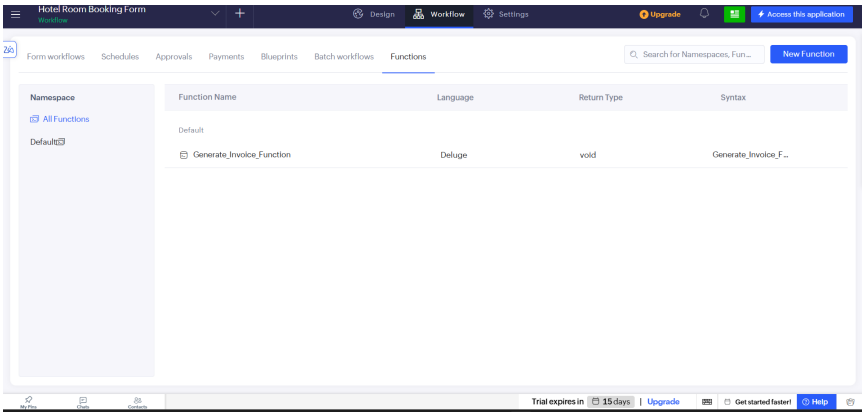
- **Purpose:** Processes automated system audit logs across room inventory blocks (e.g., 500 room units) during off-peak night audit hours.
- **Deluge Integration:** Evaluates occupancy metrics, updates room availability flags, and triggers maintenance tickets for flagged room assets.

Function Implementation (Generate_Guest_Invoice_Function)

- **Purpose:** Uses parameter link names (`Guest_Name`, `Email_address`, and `Total_Tariff`) to fetch reservation records by ID, calculate taxes, and dispatch an automated billing invoice.







RESULT

The **Hotel Room Booking Automation Suite** was successfully designed, configured, and documented using Zoho Creator's advanced workflow builder framework, covering form triggers, schedules, approvals, blueprints, batch processing, and custom Deluge functions tailored specifically to hotel front-desk and room management operations.